



Track views/reach/likes/comments/saves and post photos to Instagram.

Analytics + Posting

Involved Setup

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- A Business or Creator Instagram account
- A free Meta developer app — the same one Threads uses, if you have that too
- A long-lived access token

STEP BY STEP

1 Switch to a professional account

In the Instagram app: **Settings** → **Account type and tools** → **Switch to professional account** (Business or Creator). Personal accounts can't use the API. You can skip connecting a Facebook Page.

2 Create (or open) a Meta developer app

On **My Apps** press **Create app**. Name it anything, and on the **Use cases** step tick **Manage messaging & content on Instagram** (tick *Access the Threads API* too if you want Threads). No business portfolio is needed; finish the wizard. Already have the app? Open it and use **Add use cases**. developers.facebook.com/apps ↗

Create an app

App details • • • • • **Use cases** • • • • • Business • • • • • Requirements • • • • • Overview

☒ **Access the Threads API**
Use the Threads API and choose to authenticate users, retrieve user information, post threads, reply to threads, manage reply settings and/or gather insights for a Threads profile you own or manage on behalf of others. [About the Threads API](#)

☒ **Manage messaging & content on Instagram**
Publish posts, share stories, respond to comments, answer direct messages and more with the Instagram API. [About the Instagram API](#)

Create an app: the Use cases step, with Access the Threads API and Manage messaging & content on Instagram

3

Open the Instagram use case → API setup with Instagram login

Dashboard → **Use cases** → **Customize** next to *Manage messaging & content on Instagram* → left tab **API setup with Instagram login**. Not *with Facebook login* — that one needs a Facebook Page. Meta's welcome box says to switch for insights; ignore it, PawPoller's stats work here.

Welcome to the Instagram API

Begin using the Instagram API to create, publish, and manage content. You can also interact with users by sending and receiving messages, as well as moderating comments. [Learn more](#)

If you want to be able to track hashtags and insights, switch to the [API setup with Facebook login](#).

Instagram app name
Pawpoller-IG [Sync app name](#)

Instagram app ID

Instagram app secret
..... [Show](#)

1. Add required messaging permissions

Add the listed content management and messaging permissions to create, publish and manage content and respond directly to messages and send private replies with your Instagram account. Manage these and optional permissions and features on the Permissions and features page.

- instagram_business_basic
- instagram_business_manage_comments
- instagram_business_manage_messages

[Go to permissions and features](#)

2. Generate access tokens

Add an Instagram account to generate access tokens and set up webhook subscriptions. Before proceeding, make sure to assign the Instagram Tester role to the account in the [Roles](#) tab.

Instagram account	Token	Webhook Subscription
knaughtykat	Generate token	☐ Off

[Add account](#)

API setup with Instagram login: app name and id, section 1 messaging permissions, section 2 Generate access tokens with one tester account and a Generate token link

4

Add yourself as an Instagram Tester

App roles → **Roles** → **Add People** → pick **Instagram Tester** under *Additional roles* → your Instagram username. Then accept the invite in Instagram: **Settings** → **Apps and websites** → **Tester invites**. Until you accept, the token step will not list your account.

All roles [Administrators](#) [Developers](#) [Testers](#) **0 of 50** [More](#) [Add People](#)

Name ↑↓	Role ⓘ ↑	Status ⓘ ↑↓	Actions
Knaughty Kat	Administrator		
knaughtykat	Instagram Tester Instagram Users can manage invitations in the Apps and Websites section of the profile.		
knaughtykat	Threads Tester Threads Users can manage invitations in the Website permissions section of their profile.		

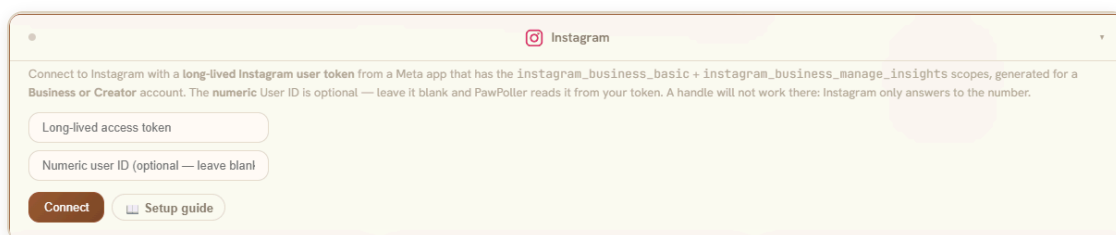
App roles: one Administrator, one Instagram Tester and one Threads Tester, with the Add People button

5 Generate the token

Back on **API setup with Instagram login**, section 2. **Generate access tokens**: press **Add account** if yours is not listed, then **Generate token**. Approve everything it asks for — the app asks for the basic, insights, publishing, comments and messages scopes in one go — and copy the whole token. Skip sections 1, 3 and 5: messaging permissions, webhooks and App Review are not needed.

6 Connect in PawPoller

Settings → Platforms → Instagram: paste the token, leave the user ID blank, press **Connect**. PawPoller reads your username back from the token — check it is the account you meant.



PawPoller Settings, Instagram card: access token, optional user id, Connect

WHERE IT GOES IN PAWPOLLER

Settings → Instagram → Access token (user id optional — leave blank)

KEEPING IT ALIVE

Long-lived tokens last ~60 days. PawPoller auto-refreshes it while polling. If it lapses, generate a fresh token in section 2 of *API setup with Instagram login* and paste it back in — the app, tester role and use case all stay valid.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Do the whole setup on a **desktop** (not mobile) in **Microsoft Edge** — or any browser that is **NOT Chrome**. Chrome reliably breaks Meta's developer dashboard and token generator: the flow silently fails or the token never appears. Edge/Firefox work.
- The **Permissions and features** table is about App Review. On the app this guide was written from, `instagram_business_manage_insights` and `instagram_business_content_publish` were never "added" there and stats arrive anyway: the token generator asks for all five Instagram scopes regardless. Add them if you like; it costs nothing.
- Every Instagram post **requires a photo** — there are no text-only posts. Instagram fetches the image from a public address, and PawPoller finds it one: your own server if you have one, otherwise the PawPoller relay (a public PawPoller server hosts the picture for 15 minutes), otherwise a temporary tunnel from your PC. Nothing to set up; see **Settings** → **Posting** → **Instagram image host** to switch either off or to download the tunnel helper.
- Leave the app **Unpublished**. Development mode with your own account needs no App Review, and the Publish button stays greyed out until you add a privacy policy — you do not need one. A public app for other users would need review and would likely be rejected for adult content.